A/PROF CHAMARA BASNAYAKE
MBBS, PhD, FRACP
Gastroenterologist & Endoscopist
PN 421926PK

FOCUS GASTROENTEROLOGY

20 May 2026

Elaine TEO

Dear Elaine TEO,

**Re: Miss Tara Dehm**
**DOB: 14/04/1995 Phone: 0408261216**
**Address: Unit 403 33 Judd Street, RICHMOND, VIC, 3121**
**Email: tara.dehm@hotmail.com**

**Summary**

- **Worsening reflux symptoms and recent hospital presentation with presumed gastritis./ Functional dyspepsia**
- **For gastroscopy to evaluate known hiatus hernia and exclude erosive oesophagitis.**
- **Requirement for a 24-hour clear liquid diet protocol prior to the procedure due to Wegovy therapy.**
- **No action required by you.**

I had the pleasure of conducting a review with Tara. She recently presented to a public emergency department on Christmas Day with severe abdominal pain, which was managed as presumed gastritis. While she was discharged on a proton pump inhibitor, she continues to experience daily symptoms of heartburn and regurgitation. She finds that rabeprazole 10 mg daily is effective in managing these symptoms, provided she remains compliant and avoids dietary triggers such as tomatoes.

Her clinical presentation is currently influenced by the commencement of Wegovy (semaglutide) in January. While she has successfully lost approximately 0.5 kg per week, she is experiencing significant side effects, including nausea and vomiting occurring several times per week. Regarding her past history, we have previously identified a hiatus hernia. I also note a new family history of coeliac disease in her sister; however, Tara's previous gastric biopsies were negative for this condition. From a psychiatric perspective, she remains stable with a diagnosis of complex PTSD, managed with fluoxetine and olanzapine. She also mentioned a tentative plan for future conception.

**Impression and Plan**

In light of the worsening reflux and her recent episode of severe epigastric pain, I have recommended a gastroscopy to assess for erosive changes and evaluate the status of her hiatus hernia. As she is taking semaglutide, I have counselled her on the associated risks of aspiration during sedation. To mitigate this, I have instructed her to follow a 24-hour clear liquid diet prior to the procedure, in addition to standard fasting on the day. She will hold her dose of Wegovy on the day of the procedure and cease fish oil supplements one week prior.

Tara also requested a recommendation for a dietitian to support her with a history of disordered eating while she continues semaglutide therapy. I have suggested she contact Erin Russel, Jessica Fitzpatrick or Sarah

All appointments and enquires
**Suite 201, 100 Victoria Parade**
**East Melbourne VIC 3002**
Ph: 03 9650 7917
Fax: 03 9650 7910
Pager: 03 9387 1000
Email: office@focusgastro.com.au

Endoscopy locations
**Epworth Freemasons Day Proc. Centre**
320 Victoria Pde, East Melbourne, 3002
**Hobson Healthcare Sydenham**
566 Melton Hwy, Sydenham, 3037
**St Vincent's Private Hospital**
59 Victoria Pde, Fitzroy, 3065

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Gilland, who have expertise in these areas. I will review Tara again following her gastroscopy.

Yours sincerely,

**A/Prof Chamara Basnayake**
Gastroenterologist


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